



AFTER

Largely due to the resistance of Southern whites, Republican control of the South began to wane in the mid-1870s.

DISPUTED RULE

Elections in the South were noted for **violence and accusations of fraud**. Many elections were contested, with Louisiana being one of the most troublesome states. In 1872 Democratic and Republican leaders claimed victory and established **rival governments in New Orleans**. Bloody battles between armed militias failed to resolve the crisis. The **Republicans were forced to compromise**, granting Democrats control of the lower house so that the Republican Governor could stay in office.

RETURN OF DEMOCRATIC CONTROL

States with **white voting majorities** were the first to elect Democrats. By 1875 Virginia, Georgia, Texas, Alabama, Mississippi, Tennessee, and Arkansas were **led by Democrats**. The rest of the South was "redeemed" in the **election of 1876** and its eventual compromise (see [Contested election](#)).